



Natick Public Schools
Presentation to Town Meeting
April 29, 2025



APPRECIATION

This budget reflects a shared commitment to student success, built on collaboration and trust across our entire community

We are grateful to:

- **Natick Voters** for passing the March 2025 override
- **Natick School Committee** for their leadership and advocacy
- **School and District Leaders, Educators, and Staff** for their daily dedication to our students
- **Families and Students** for their partnership, engagement, and perseverance

We also thank our broader community partners:

- **Parent-Teacher Organizations** and **Booster Clubs** for their tireless volunteerism and support
- **Volunteers** who contribute time and talent across all our schools
- **Natick Education Foundation** for championing innovation and enrichment
- **Community-Based Partners** – including **SPARK Kindness, Natick 180, Morse Institute Library**, and others – for supporting the whole child
- **Facilities, Public Works, Police, and Fire Departments** for ensuring safe, well-maintained, and welcoming school environments
- **School-Town Partnership Members** – including the **Select Board, Town Administrator, Town Treasurer, and Finance Committee** – for their collaboration and stewardship

FY26 Budget - Community Outreach - 19 Public Meetings

6 School Committee Meetings

- Several Budget Review and Override Updates
- Joint with Select Board and FinCom - Budget Discussion
- Public Hearing

5 FinCom Meetings

- Education & Learning Subcommittee Virtual Meetings
- Full Committee Meetings

3 Public Forums

- Held at Morse Library and the Community Senior Center

3 Community Meetings

- Home events
- Community Senior Center

2 PTO Meetings

SCHOOL COMMITTEE GUIDANCE, PRIORITIES & VALUES

- Meet contractual agreements to allow NPS to **hire, develop and maintain the best educators** for Natick students
- **Measurably improve student achievement** with particular focus on Math and Literacy
- Ensure **Special Education and ELL programs** are funded to meet the needs of every student
- Measure progress towards a **district culture** where each student feels **safe and has a sense of belonging**
- Support the Superintendent in **developing the next Strategic Plan**, including a detailed School Department **Five-Year Capital Plan**, by leveraging the insights and recommendations from the Superintendent's entry plan.
- Maintain a **robust set of offerings both during and after school** to provide students with diverse experiences to enable them to develop life skills, including critical thinking, communication, collaboration, problem-solving and creativity while also facilitating measurable improvement in student sense of belonging.
- Develop a **comprehensive long-term capital strategy for our elementary schools**, including participation in the eligibility process of the MSBA.

School & Finance Committee Approved FY26 BUDGET

FY25 Appropriation	\$86,795,299
FY25 Bus subsidy	\$429,844
FY25 Appropriation & bus subsidy	\$87,225,143
FY26 Budget Increase from Adjusted Total	10%
FY26 Budget Increase in Dollars	\$8,696,605
FY26 School & Finance Committee Approved Budget*	\$95,491,904

* Includes FY25 Bus Subsidy \$429,844

FY26 BUDGET DRIVERS -

Investing in Educators & Instruction

- **+\$4.7M 54.4% of Total Increase**
- **Contractual Salary Obligations & Bargaining Year Adjustments;**
- **Recent settlements bring us to state averages & below while still retaining the excellent of our staff**

Operational Costs & Efficiencies

- **Administration (+2.0%, \$160K)** – Staff reductions offset higher legal costs
- **Technology (+4.1%, \$54K)** – Investments in network infrastructure and security
- **Facilities (-5.6%, -\$170K)** – Reduced custodial, maintenance, and utility costs

Expanding Student Services

- **Special Education Tuition (+\$2.76M, 31.8%)**
 - No one-time Circuit Breaker carryover funds (\$2M impact)
 - Increase due to higher state tuition rates and more students
- **Transportation (+\$837K, 19%)**
 - 5.3% contract increase for bus services
 - Elimination of \$429K school bus subsidy shifts costs to the school budget

Cost Reductions (\$1.4M)

- **Staffing Reductions (\$460K, 10 FTEs)**
 - Eliminated positions & minimized impact on students
- **Expense Reductions (\$725K)**
 - Professional development cuts
 - Digital program adjustments to streamline resources
 - Operational efficiencies in supplies and services
- **Increased Fees (\$215K)** - Athletics, transportation, other

BUDGET GOAL

Our goal is to balance fiscal responsibility, strategic reductions, and budget-neutral solutions while preserving high-quality education and student-facing positions.



NPS Art by Alex, Grade 2



[Link to FY26 NPS Budget Book](https://natickschools.info/FY26Budget)



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